

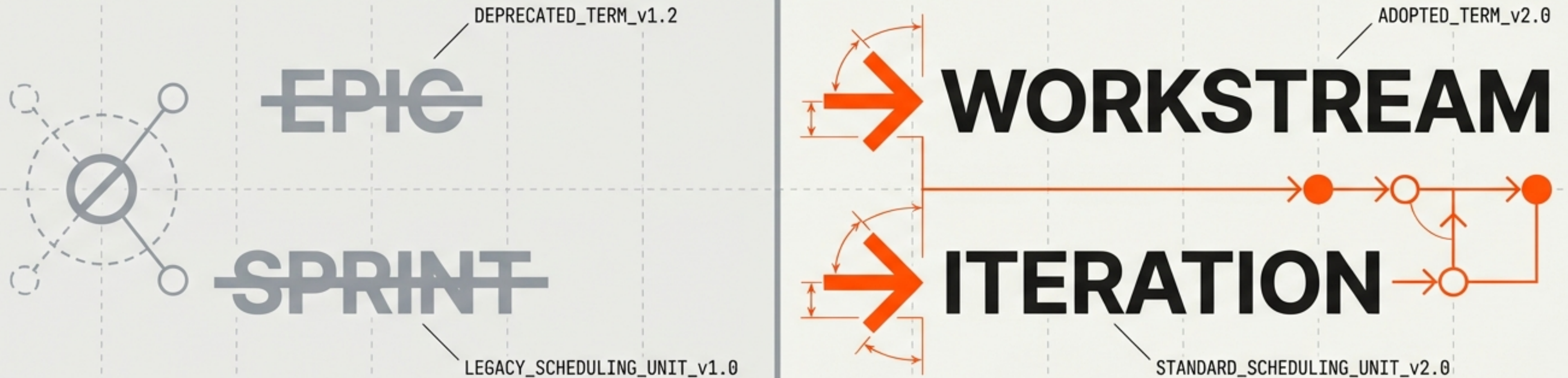
NAMING DECISION: WORKSTREAM & ITERATION

STATUS: ADOPTED

DATE: 10 FEB 2026

CONTEXT: TERMINOLOGY REFACTOR

We are aligning our terminology with reality.

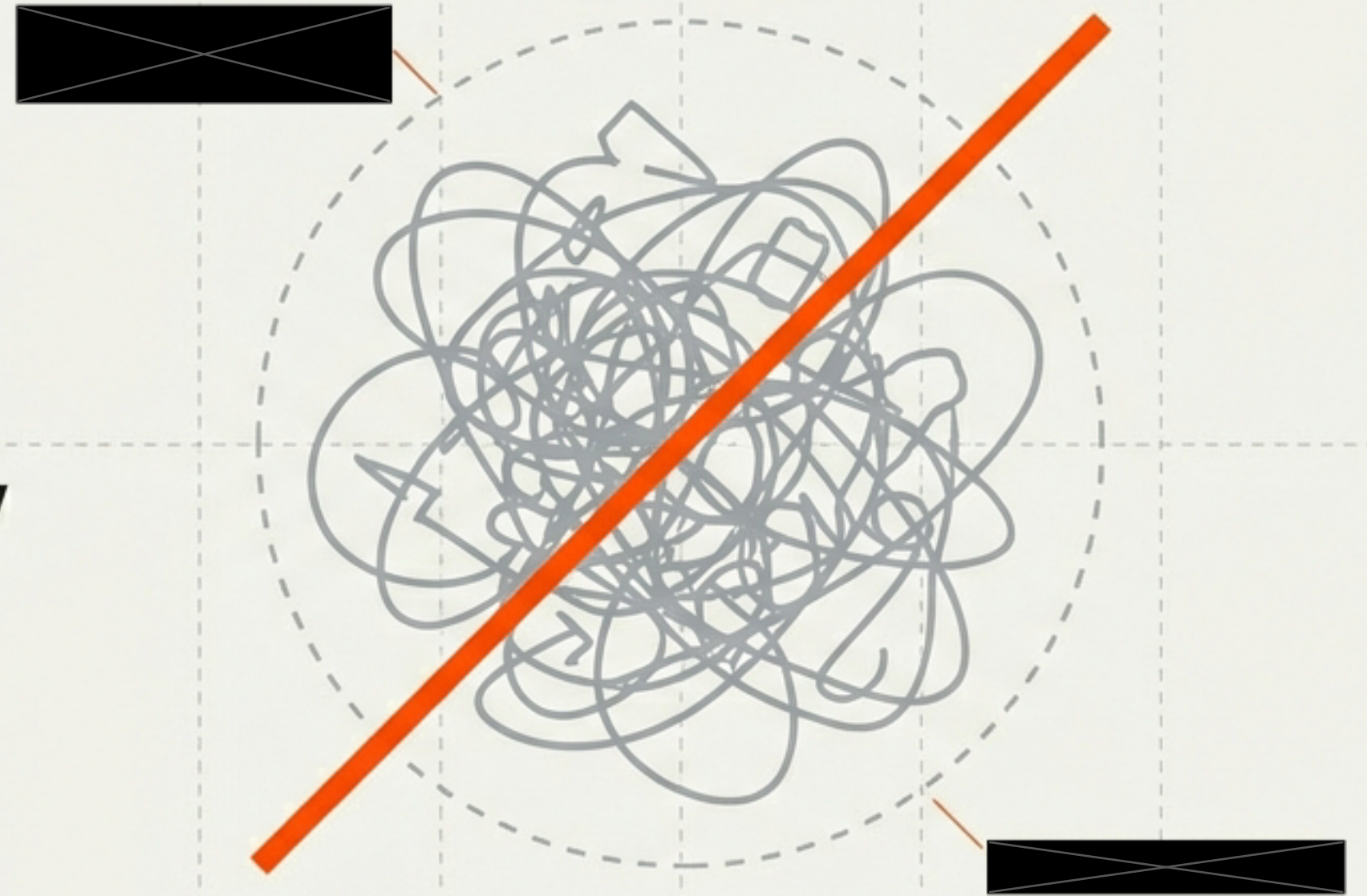


OFFICIAL_MEMO // SYSTEM_UPDATE_v2.1 // DATE: 2024.05.15

We are retiring 'Epic' and 'Sprint' effective immediately. We are adopting 'Workstream' and 'Iteration' as our primary terms for grouping and scheduling work in this project.

Language shapes how we build.

We value **HONESTY**
over mythology and flow over
artificial urgency. The terms we
use must describe the
mechanism of work as it actually
REALITY happens, not as a
generic industry metaphor.



OFFICIAL_MEMO // LANGUAGE_POLICY_v1.2 // DATE: 2024.05.16

This decision removes the methodological baggage of Scrum and Jira to focus on the reality of our development process.

**‘Epic’ implies mythology
where none is needed.**

**‘Epic’ is Jira terminology
that has leaked into general
usage. It obfuscates the
goal. It is simply a group of
related work, yet the
name suggests a grand
narrative arc.**



OFFICIAL_MEMO // LANGUAGE_POLICY_v1.3 // DATE: 2024.05.17 // TECHNICAL_NOTE: DEPRECATION_OF_EPIC_TERM

A label should describe what the object is, not dramatise it.

‘Sprint’ implies artificial urgency.

‘Sprint’ carries heavy Scrum methodology baggage. It implies speed as a default setting and fixes focus on a calendar date rather than the output.



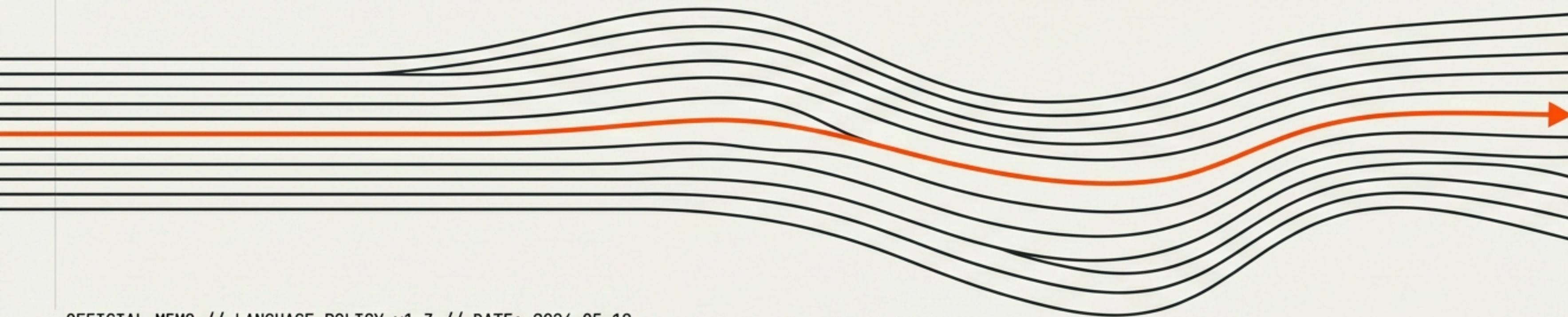
OFFICIAL_MEMO // LANGUAGE_POLICY_v1.3 // DATE: 2024.05.18

Our work is driven by “what does done look like”, not by an arbitrary race to a deadline.

The Workstream

DEFINITION: A container of related work towards a specific goal (e.g., 'MVP Release Infrastructure').

Rationale: It says exactly what it is: a stream of work flowing in a specific direction. It is clear, carries no baggage, and implies continuous movement rather than a static bucket.



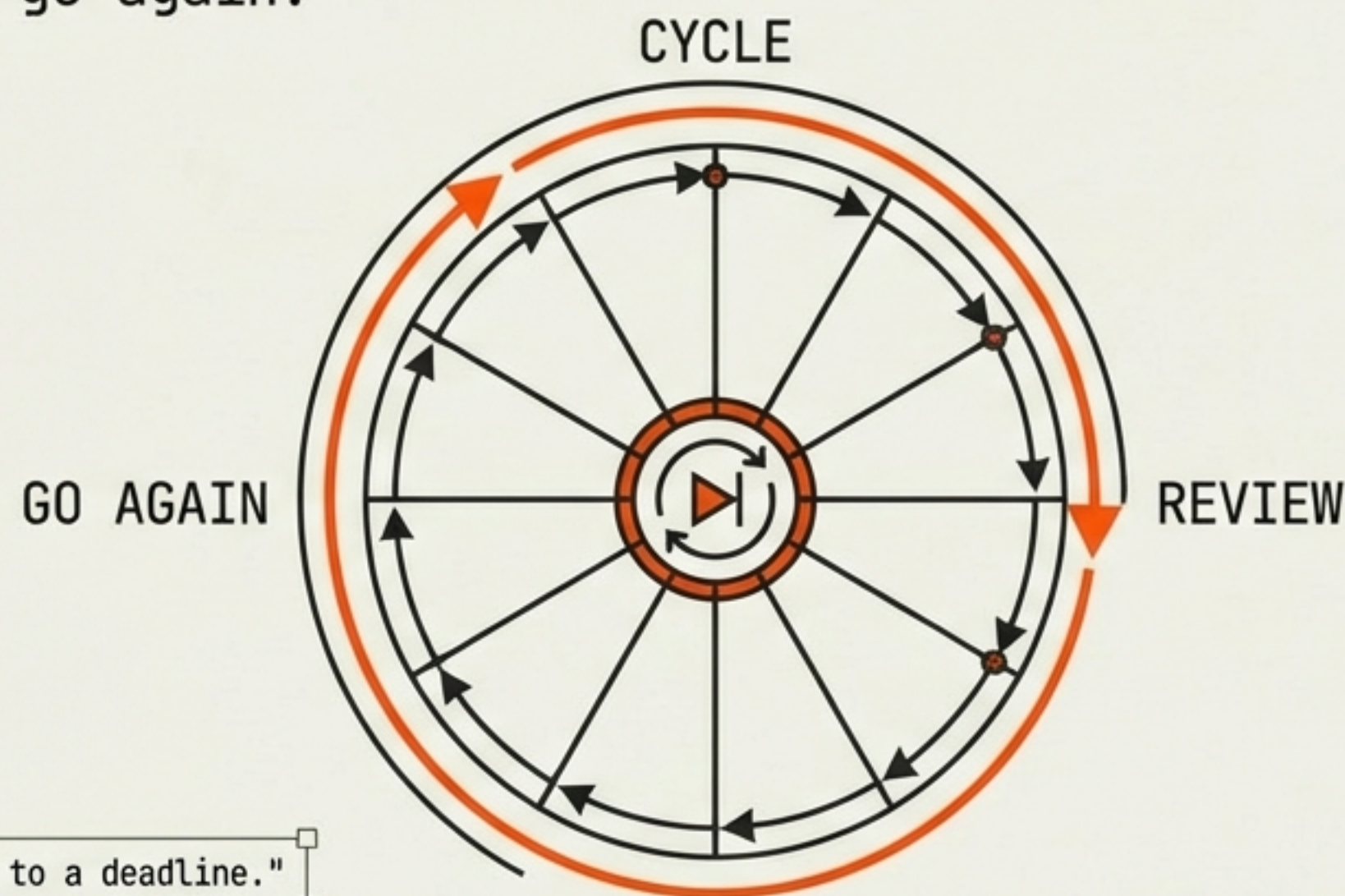
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"Our work is driven by 'what does done look like', not by an arbitrary race to a deadline."

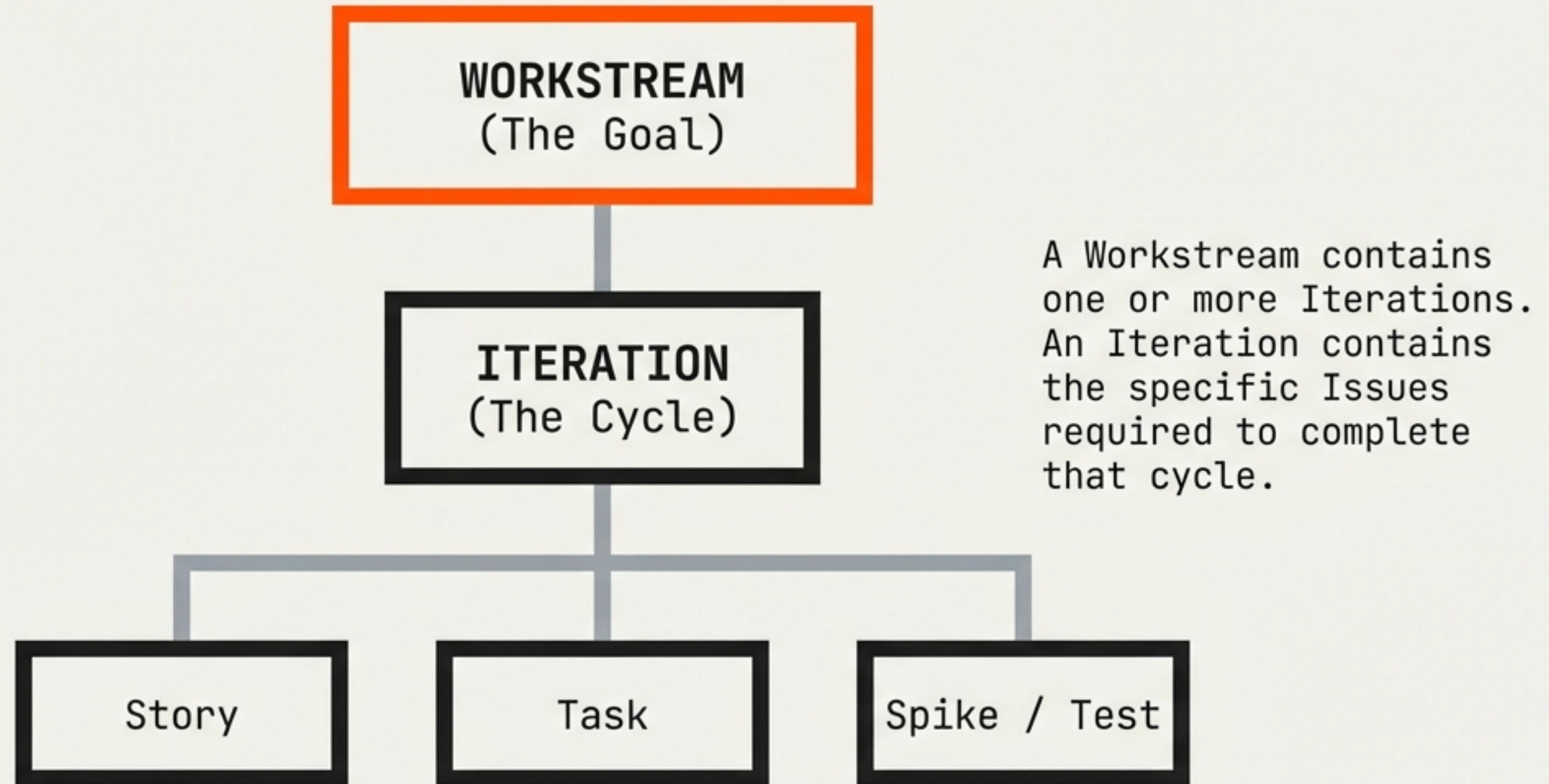
The Iteration

DEFINITION: A time-bound cycle of work within a workflow.

Rationale: Iteration is honest about the process. It is mechanical and rhythmic, not frantic. We do a cycle. We review. We go again.



The New Hierarchy



Alternatives Considered: Grouping Work

NAME	RATIONALE FOR REJECTION
WORKSTREAM	Clear, no baggage. CHOSEN.
Brief	Conflates the “container of work” with the “document describing it”.
Track	Too generic; could mean anything.
Batch	Honest, but feels transactional and lacks direction.
Phase	Better suited for macro-level roadmaps, not individual work groups.
Initiative	Too corporate and formal for our style.
Wave	Works well metaphorically, but slightly too abstract.

Alternatives Considered: Time-Bound Cycles

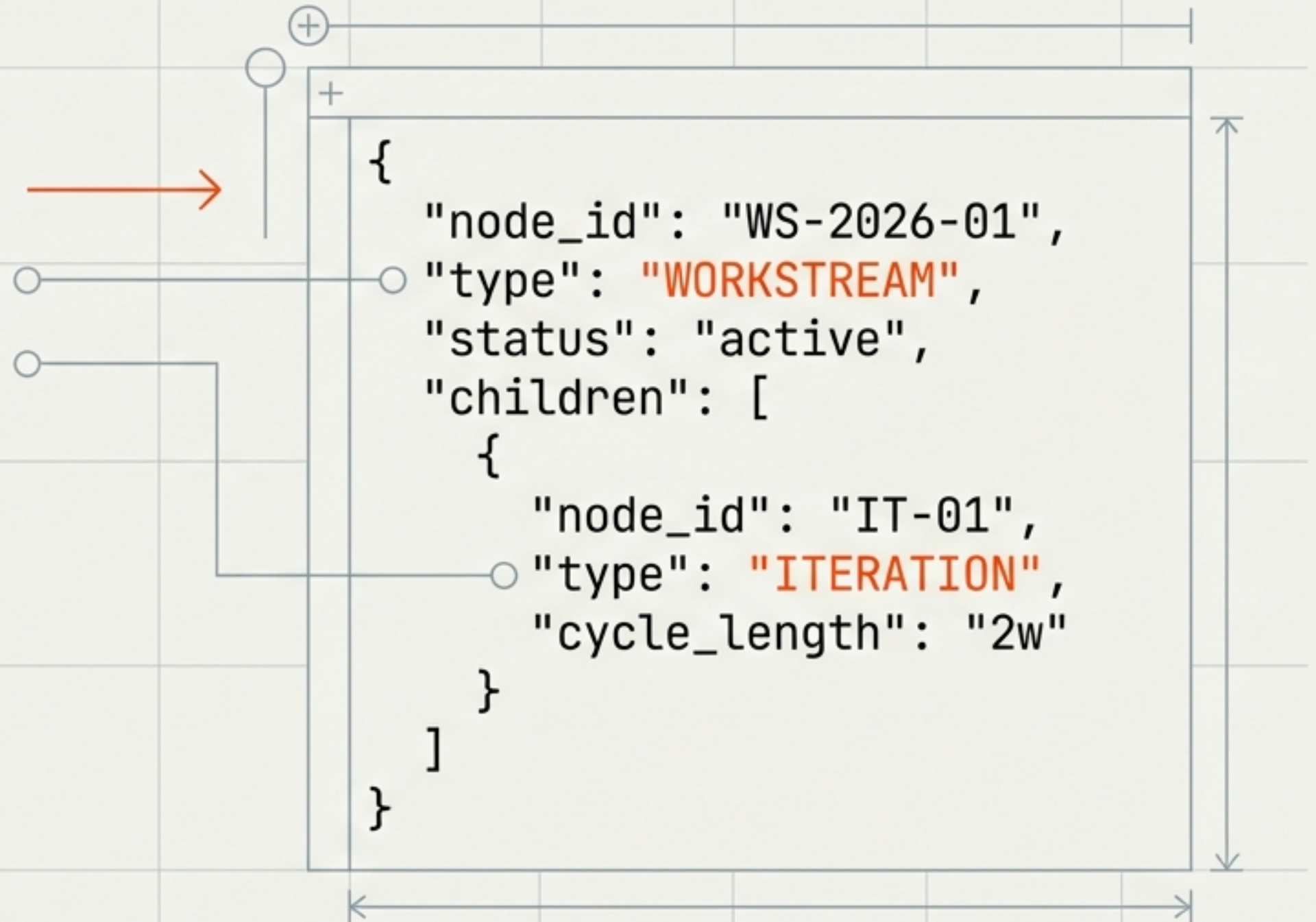
NAME	RATIONALE FOR REJECTION
ITERATION	Honest, self-explanatory. CHOSEN.
Cycle	Neutral, but feels slightly too mechanical.
Push	Action-oriented, but implies urgency (similar problem to 'Sprint').
Drop	Derived from release culture; focuses more on output than the process.
Round	Simple, but feels a bit informal and lacks direction.
Milestone	Rejected because it is a marker, not a container of work.

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System Integration

Workstream and Iteration are now first-class node types in Issues FS. They exist alongside standard types (Story, Task, Spike).

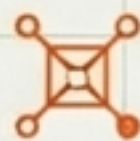


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'Our work is driven by 'what does done look like', not by an arbitrary race to a deadline.'

Protocol for Agents & Humans

01



Use these terms in all documentation, issues, and daily communication going forward.

02



Update existing references. If you encounter 'Epic' or 'Sprint' in legacy docs, refactor them to the new terminology immediately.

Definitions & Hierarchy

WORKSTREAM

Replaces 'Epic'

A container of related work towards a specific goal.

ITERATION

Replaces 'Sprint'

A time-bound cycle of work within a workstream.

Workstream



Iteration

